

The Future Success of Shohei Ohtani

Forecasting His MLB Performance

A data-driven prediction using production trends, age curve, and risk scenarios

Forecasting Presentation

Week Four • August 13

Ohtani's Road to the Dodgers

From two-way sensation to four-time unanimous MVP.

Dodgers chapter

Signed with the Dodgers in December 2023 on a 10-year, \$700 million contract.

MLB MVP history

2021 AL Angels • unanimous

2023 AL Angels • unanimous

2024 NL Dodgers • unanimous

2025 NL Dodgers • unanimous

Four MVP awards—all unanimous. Only Barry Bonds has won more.



My Forecast Question

How do we define “future success” for a once-in-a-generation player?

Forecast question

Based on Ohtani’s past performance and current indicators, how productive will he be from 2027–2030?

Success will be measured through:

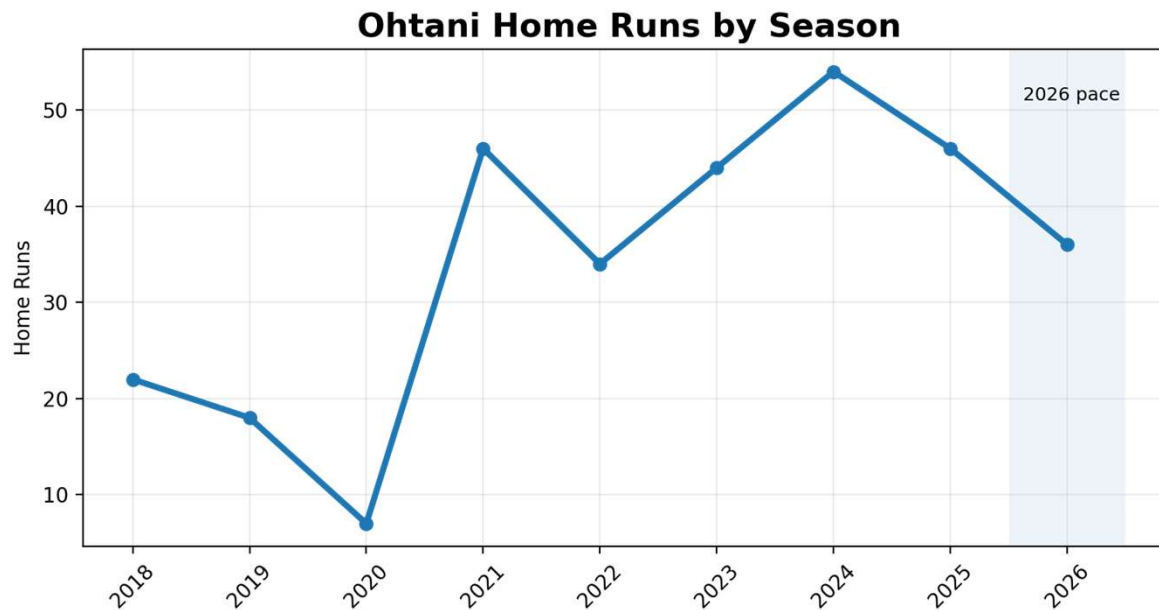
Power	Home runs / slugging
Overall hitting	OPS / expected quality of contact
Two-way value	Pitching availability + workload
Longevity	Age curve + injury risk

Main forecast: Ohtani remains elite, but his success shifts from historic peak seasons to high-level, controlled production as he moves deeper into his 30s.



Historical Pattern: Elite Power, Not a One-Year Spike

Completed seasons plus 2026 pace show a sustained high-power profile.



What the trend shows

- Ohtani's 2021–2025 seasons show repeated 40+ HR ability.
- The model should not treat 2024 as the only “normal” outcome.
- 2026 is still in progress, so the chart uses a season pace estimate.

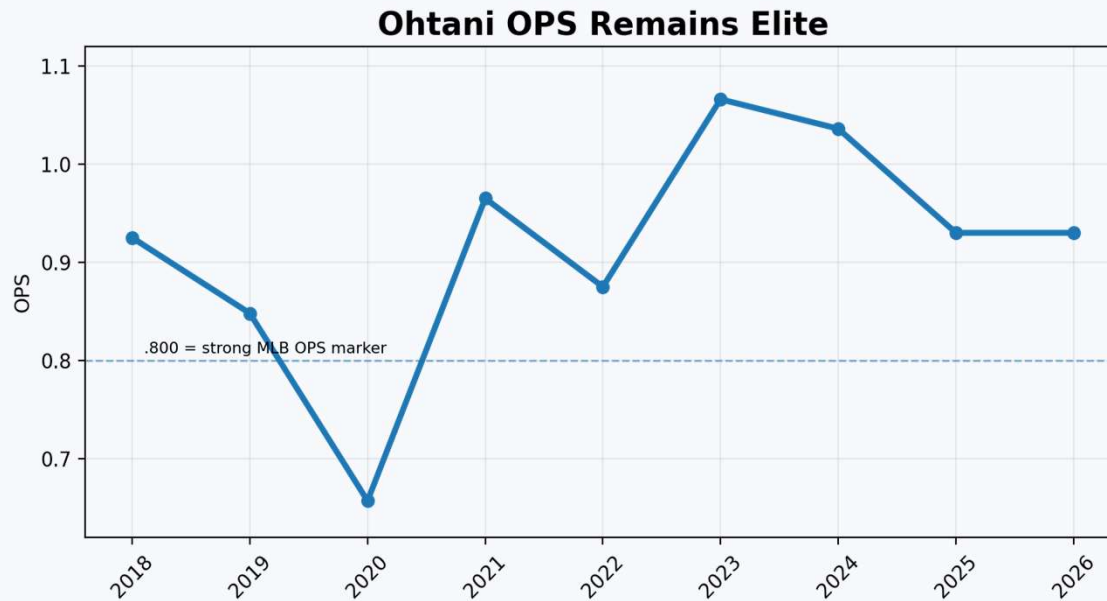
Model choice

A simple forecast should combine recent trend + age curve, rather than a straight line from rookie year to now.

2026 note: Reuters reported Ohtani's 27th HR on Aug. 13; pace rounded to mid-30s for a full-season estimate.

Why the Forecast Stays Optimistic

Ohtani's underlying hitting quality still supports elite outcomes.



Statcast indicators

Avg exit velocity **93+ mph**

Hard-hit rate **~52-54%**

xwOBA **~.405-.412**

Barrel rate **~16%+**

Interpretation: even if yearly results move around, the quality of contact suggests the power is still real.

Forecasting Model: Simple, Explainable, and Honest

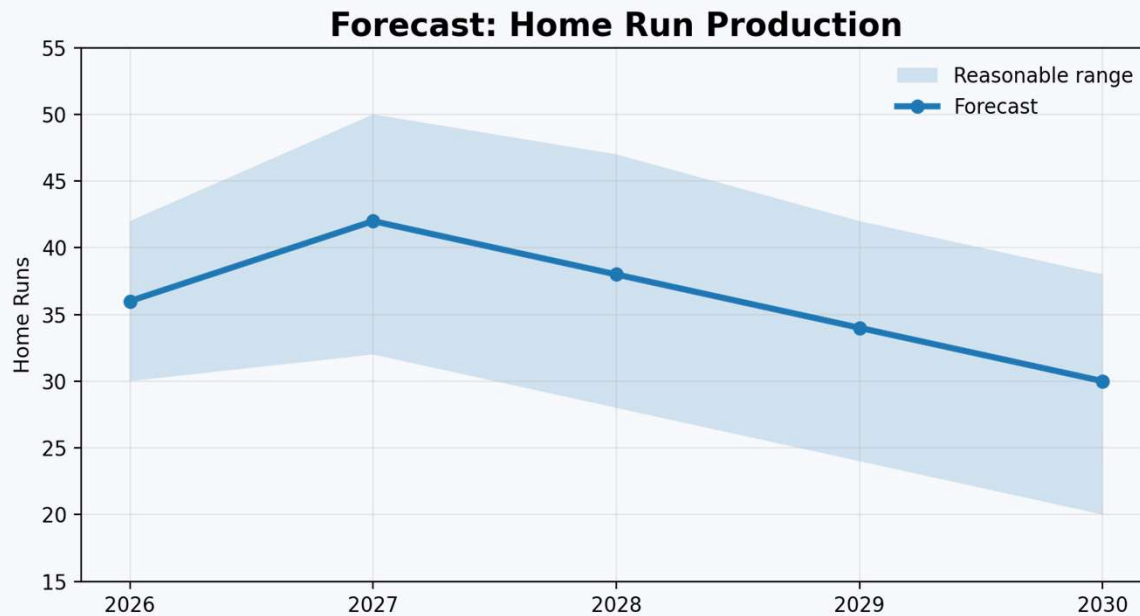
The goal is not a perfect prediction; it is a supported prediction with clear assumptions.



Base-case equation: $\hat{HR} = 42 - 4 \times (\text{Year} - 2027)$

Forecast: High Production, Gradual Decline

Base case: Ohtani remains a star, but not every year will look like 2024.



Base-case forecast

2027	42 HR
2028	38 HR
2029	34 HR
2030	30 HR

Prediction: over the next four full seasons, he projects for about 140–150 home runs if he stays healthy.

The Two-Way Factor Changes the Forecast

Ohtani's value is not only batting: pitching availability can make "success" much bigger.



Two versions of future success

Hitter-only success

40-ish HR seasons, elite OPS, MVP conversation when healthy.

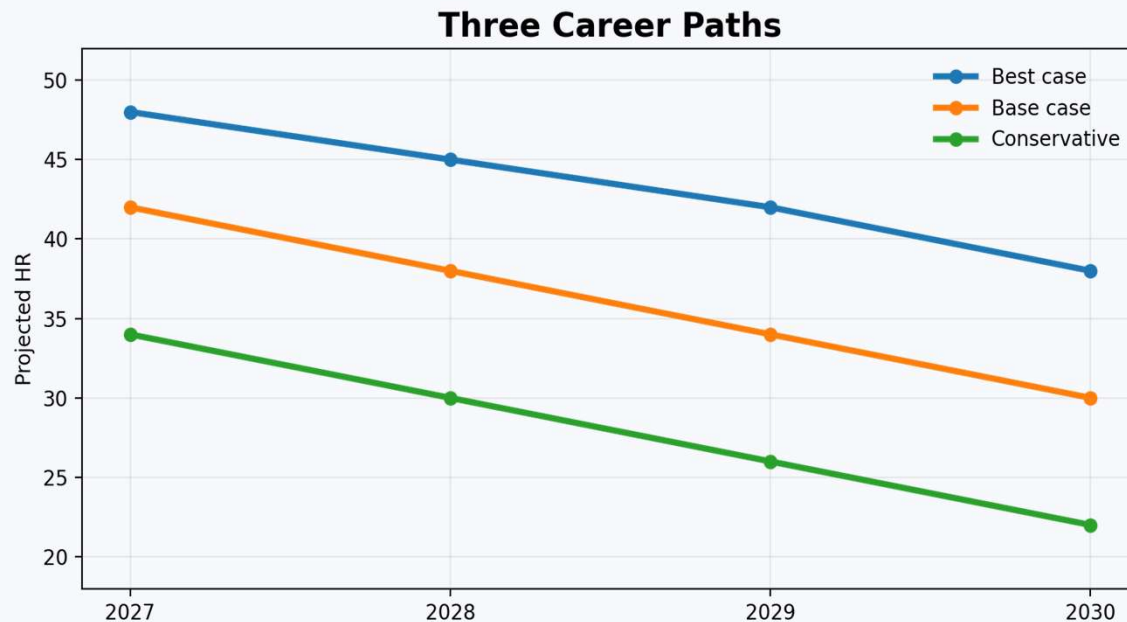
Two-way success

Even moderate pitching volume raises his total value because very few players can contribute as both a top hitter and pitcher.

Health + workload management are the swing variables.

Uncertainty: Three Possible Career Paths

Forecasting should show a range, not just one number.



Best case

Stays healthy, power remains elite, and pitching returns regularly.

Base case

Elite hitter with controlled pitching workload and gradual age decline.

Conservative

Injuries or workload reduce games, pitching innings, and yearly HR totals.

Key risk variables: age, health, innings pitched, lineup protection, ballpark effects, and changes in MLB run environment.

Final Forecast

Ohtani's future success is most likely to remain elite through 2030, but the shape of that success will depend on health and how often he can contribute as a pitcher.

My base-case prediction

140–150 HR from 2027–2030

Still an MVP-level player when healthy, with two-way impact creating the highest-upside scenario.

The safest conclusion: not “will he stay great?” — but “how great, and in what role?”

References

Public sources used for the forecast and current season context.

Baseball-Reference: Shohei Ohtani career batting totals and season-by-season statistics.

FanGraphs: Ohtani batting WAR, AVG/OBP/SLG, and career value context.

Baseball Savant / Statcast: exit velocity, hard-hit rate, barrel rate, xwOBA, and pitching profile.

ESPN: 2026 season batting line and OPS snapshot.

Reuters: Aug. 13, 2026 game report noting Ohtani's 27th home run of the season.

Note: 2026 is an in-progress season, so any full-season number in the charts is a pace/projection, not a completed total.